

PROMPT ENGINEERING

Prompt engineering is mostly dead.

Almost every course still teaches it.

Four techniques died in the last eighteen months.

Every one of them was genuine craft at the time.

DEAD 1 OF 4

Chain-of-thought

"Let's think step by step" was a real unlock in 2023.
Current models reason by default.

The phrase is now a no-op.

DEAD 2 OF 4

Few-shot scaffolding

Still useful occasionally.

No longer the core skill it was taught as.

DEAD 3 OF 4

Instruction budgets

The old advice was to ration instructions, because models dropped them around 150 or 200. That ceiling moved by roughly an order of magnitude.

Cramming stopped being the constraint.

DEAD 4 OF 4

Role-play openers

"You are a world-class copywriter" does close to nothing now.

STILL LOAD-BEARING

What did not die

- Knowing what you actually want
- Saying it so a literal reader gets it right
- Recognising when the output is confidently wrong
- Being able to prove it either way

That half got harder, not easier.

While the tricks were working, they hid how much of the difficulty was judgment all along.

full/REFIT

The courses are still selling the tricks.

I teach the other half. Four weeks, live, twelve seats, starting August 10.

Take a seat, \$997

(Link in the first comment)